

Applied A.I. Solutions

Agile Project Management Methodologies

Quotations, Reference and Recommended Bibliography:

- 1 - "The Epic Guide to Agile – More Business Value On A Predictable Schedule With Scrum" – Author: Dave Todaro - Copyright © 2019 David M. Todaro – Published by R9 Publishing LLC
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Agile Project Management Methodologies

Ritual + Rhythm + Communication + Value +
Commitment + Teamwork + Discipline + Transparency
+ Continuous Improvement + Rapid Development

Week 3 / Day 1

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Agile Estimation

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Agile Estimation

- Collaborating with the product owner
- Agile estimation is a team sport

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Scrum Ceremonies: Sprint Planning Summary

- Timing: beginning of the sprint
- Attendees: Product Owner, Scrum Master, development team
- Timebox:

Sprints of	1-week		2-week		3-week		4 weeks or calendar month
duration	2 hrs. max		4 hrs. max		6 hrs. max		8 hrs. max

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Scrum Ceremonies: Sprint Planning Summary – cont'd

- Agenda:
 1. The development team determines the **capacity** of the team expressed in hours that they can dedicate to this sprint during its calendar duration.
 2. The Product Owner summarizes the first product backlog item for the development team to refresh their memory.
 3. The development team breaks the product backlog item down into subtasks and drive it to a shippable state (quality + completeness) and estimate the total hours required for each subtask.
 4. The development team reviews the total hours estimated for all the subtasks identified so far and compares it to the total hours available (capacity)

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Scrum Ceremonies: Sprint Planning Summary – cont'd

- Agenda – cont'd:
 5. The development team repeats steps 2-4 until they feel comfortable that the total hours they have estimated can be completed within their capacity.
 6. The development team selects a sprint goal based on the product backlog items that fit into the sprint.
 7. If the project management tool being used requires that the sprint is “started”, the Scrum Master completes the steps to start the sprint.
 8. Each team member volunteers for a subtask or two that they’ll work on between the end of sprint planning and the first daily scrum.

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Scrum Ceremonies: Sprint Planning Summary – cont'd

- Outcomes:
 1. The sprint backlog has been created with the product backlog items broken down into subtasks, each with an hour estimate.
 2. A sprint goal has been determined and written down.
 3. Any steps to start a sprint in the project management tool being used have been completed.
 4. Each development team member has volunteered for the first subtask they'll be focus on completing prior to the next daily scrum.

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Estimate schedule with a Release Burndown Chart.

- The focus of most Scrum teams is on more a short-term goal, often measured in terms of months.
- The short-term goal is defined by the Product Owner and is aligned with the needs of stakeholders and the organization.
- The goal is represented for a **subset of the product backlog**, starting at the top and including everything the product owner believes should be the next milestone for development of the product.
- This group of product items is called a **Release** and allows tracking progress towards the goal and forecasting a timeframe to reach it.

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Estimated schedule with a Release Burndown Chart – cont'd

- The amount of work remaining is driven by s size estimate, measure in **Story Points**.

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- **Story Points**

- Story points are units of measure for expressing an estimate of the overall effort required to fully implement a product backlog item or any other piece of work.
- Teams assign story points relative to work complexity, the amount of work, and risk or uncertainty.
- Values are assigned to more effectively break down work into smaller pieces, so they can address uncertainty.
- Helps teams understand how much they can achieve in a period of time and builds consensus and commitment to the solution.

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Estimated schedule with a Release Burndown Chart – cont'd

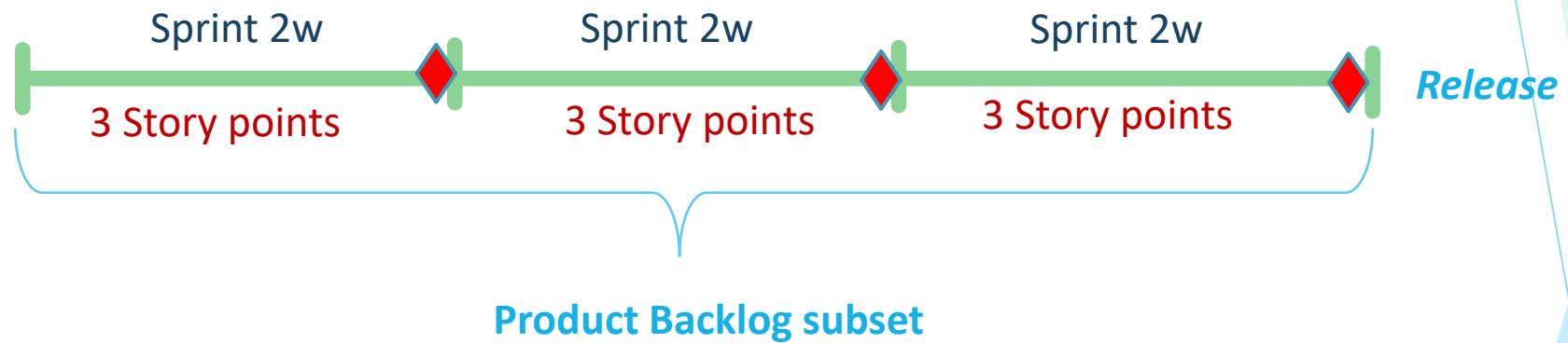
- The speed of the Team is determined by how many story points they have completed during prior sprints, which is called **velocity**.
- Typically, an average velocity of the last three sprints is used for the release burndown.

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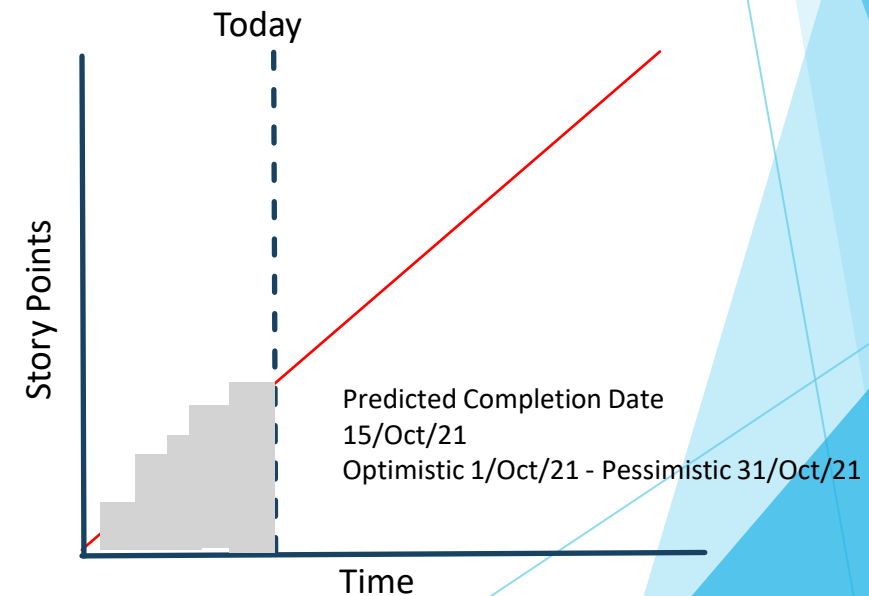
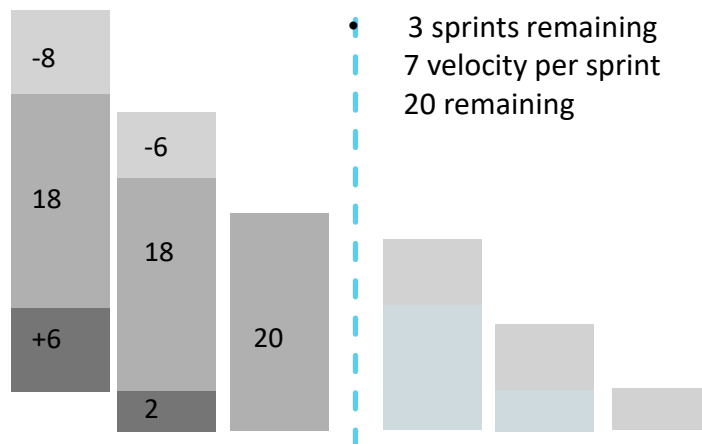


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Range of Dates with Version Report

- Other types of charts and reports can be used to track progress with the current release.
- **Jira** includes different types of reports which uses the same information as the release burndown (velocity of the team and the amount of work remaining).



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Predict Team's Velocity

- Use historical information
- Run a few sprints (ideal)
- Break down a few stories into subtasks

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Predict Team's Velocity – cont'd

Break down a few stories into subtasks:

1. Determine gross capacity: for a typical sprint, determine how many hours the development team members can spend focused solely on this product
2. Determine net capacity: subtract Scrum ceremony time from the gross capacity number to come up with the net capacity
3. Select stories from the product backlog: select a handful of stories from the product backlog that have different story point size estimates.

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Predict Team's Velocity – cont'd

Break down a few stories into subtasks:

4. Break down a user story: define the subtasks (1 day or less) that are required to drive the first story to “done”, each task an hour estimate
5. Repeat: repeat the process until the net capacity hour estimate is consumed
6. Determine velocity: add up the points from the stories that “fit”, and use that as your estimated velocity

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Capacity estimate - Example

Team Member	Hour per week	Other projects	Emails + other meetings	Gross Capacity per week	Gross Capacity (2w - Sprint)	Sprint Planning	Daily Scrum	Backlog Refinement	Sprint Review	Retrospective	Net Capacity
Emma	40	15	5	20	40	4	2	2	1	1	29
Ben	40	10	5	25	50	4	2	2	1	1	39
John	40		10	30	60	4	2	2	1	1	49
Maria	40	5	5	30	60	4	2	2	1	1	49
Lucas	40		15	25	50	4	2	2	1	1	39
											205 hrs. per sprint

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Break down the story

Subtasks	Hours
Write acceptance tests, review, and make edits	2
Write online help. Reviews, and make edits	4
Create technical implementation strategy and review with team	6
Create user interface layout including style edits	0.25
Create feature branch in source code repository	4
Write unit tests and code for front end	4
Write unit tests and code for backend – framework of the story	4
Write unit tests and code for backend – additional functionality	4
Insurance for unexpected coding issues	4
Run acceptance tests	2
Fix bugs	4
Peer code review, edits, and merge feature branch	2
Product Owner review	2
Adjustments from Product Owner review	2
Total	44.25 hrs.

- Break down the story
- Repeat the process Unit Net capacity is Consumed
- Determine the velocity

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Break down the story

- Determine the velocity

As a Shopper, I want to review my cart, so I can adjust prior to checkout

5

As a Shopper, I want to view a list of products, so I can select some to purchase

13

As a Shopper, I want to review my orders, so I can see what I have purchased in the past

3

Estimated Velocity = 21 story points per sprint

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Break down the story

Determine the velocity

- Apply the calculated velocity to the total story points in your product backlog and answer to “How long will it take?”

For example:

- 100 story points for the MVP
- Estimated Velocity = 21
- 2 weeks per sprint
- $100 \text{ story points} / 21 \text{ story points per sprint} = 4.8 \text{ sprints}$, (approx. 5 sprints)
- $5 \text{ sprints} * 2 \text{ weeks per sprint} = 10 \text{ weeks total}$
- IT IS NOT YET THE FINAL NUMBER!!!

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Addressing Uncertainty - Cone of Uncertainty

- As you have zero track record, estimates might be off by quite a bit
- As you get experience, along with proven track record, uncertainty will diminish
- The Cone of Uncertainty is used to address the challenge
- Using scaling factors based on how many sprints have been completed, you can adjust the estimated velocity to create a range of completion timeframes

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Addressing Uncertainty – cont'd

- Using the average velocity of the team, and the cone of uncertainty factors, update the forecasted completion date range
- There will always be a degree of uncertainty, so your estimates will never get better than plus or minus 10%
- Using the same example, and using factors of 1.6 and 0.6 for Cone of Uncertainty

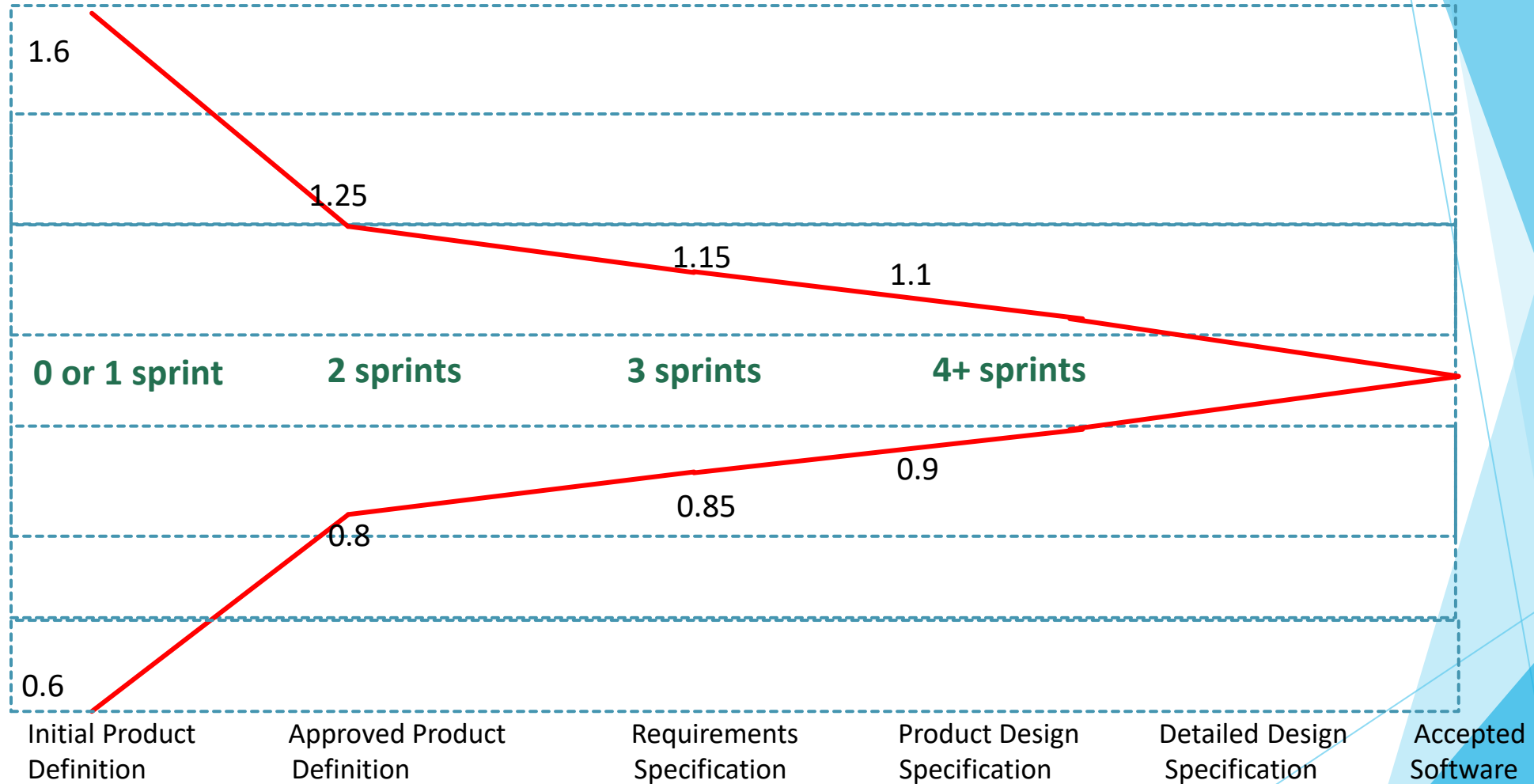
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Cone of Uncertainty



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Cone of Uncertainty – cont'd

- Optimistic Velocity = $21 * 1.6 = 33.6$ story points per sprint
- Pessimistic Velocity = $21 * 0.6 = 12.6$ story points per sprint
- Optimistic Duration = $100 \text{ story points} / 33.6 = 3 \text{ sprints} * 2 \text{ weeks} = 6 \text{ weeks}$
- Pessimistic Duration = $100 \text{ story points} / 12.6 = 8 \text{ sprints} * 2 \text{ weeks} = 16 \text{ weeks}$
- Estimated Duration = 6 to 16 weeks

Sprint Completed	Uncertainty Factor	Velocity Range	Duration Range
0 to 1	0.6 – 1.6	12.6 – 33.6	6 – 16
2	0.8 – 1.25	16.8 – 26.3	8 – 12
3	0.85 – 1.15	17.9 – 24.2	8 – 11
4+	0.9 – 1.1	18.9 – 23.1	9 – 11

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Agile Testing

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Test environments

- Testing at the end is not compatible with agile methodology.
- The Product must be potentially shippable at the end of each sprint.
- Developers must perform their own testing of new stories and fix every bug they have created during the sprint.
- Best Practice: developers have a testing environments that are like production, avoiding testing in their own workstations.
- Best Practice: two separate “Team Test” environments and a “Product Owner” environment for acceptance.

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Test environments – cont'd

- Development Team should have control over the environments.
- Leverage and use of a virtual cloud infrastructure to create and maintain environments for the Scrum team such as AWS and MS Azure.
- Leverage and use of continuous deployment tools, that automate the process of building and deploying code too test environments.
- Use of branching is also very useful to isolate new development from the main product source code and merging it back once testing is complete
- Use of distributed Version Control system as an effective collaboration tool and branching (such as Git Flow)

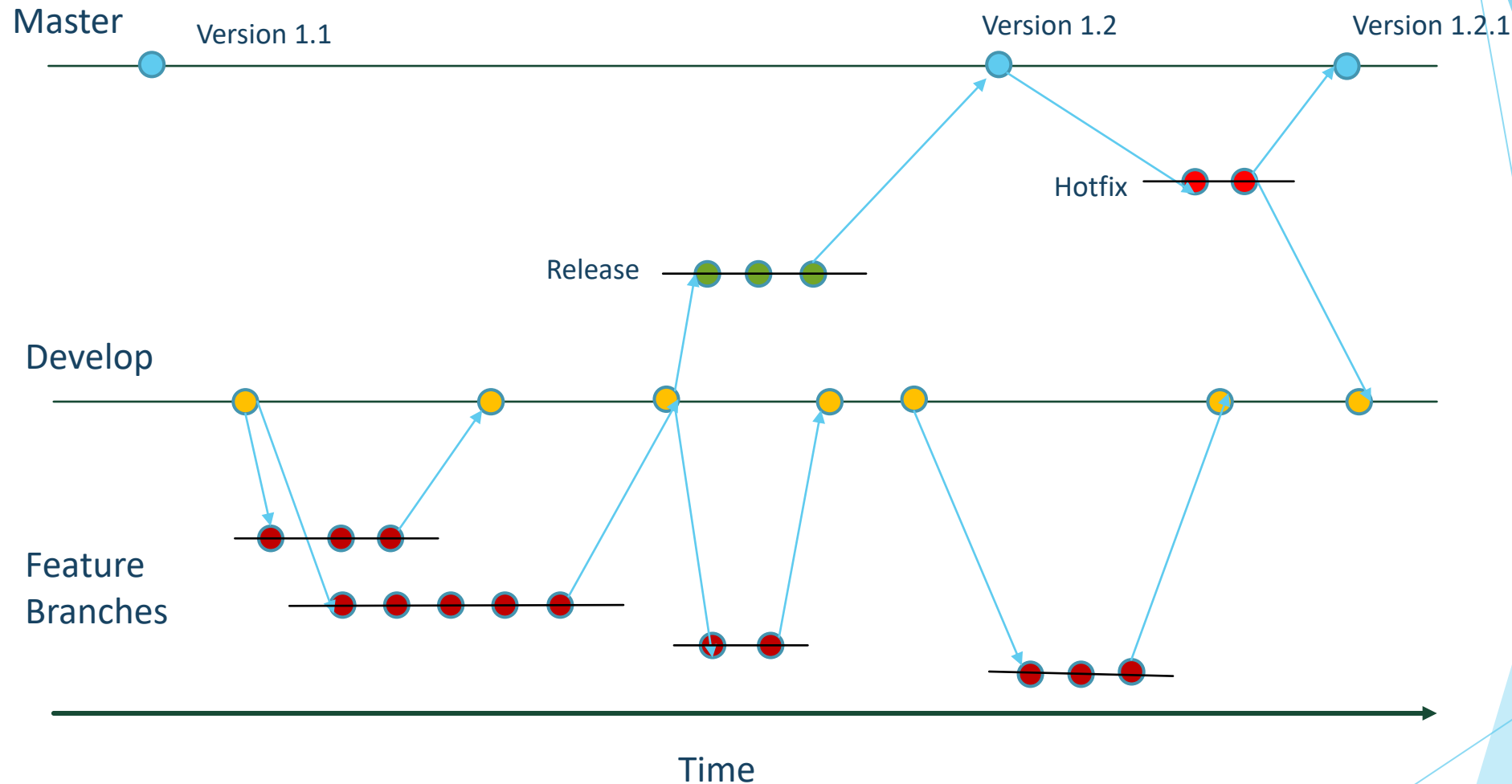
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Test environments – cont'd



Known as the Git Flow process <https://git-scm.com/>

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Five Step Release Process

1. Isolate source code for the release
2. Certify the release branch in the staging environment
3. Merge the release branch into the master branch
4. Certify the master branch in the pre-release environment
5. Certify the master branch in production

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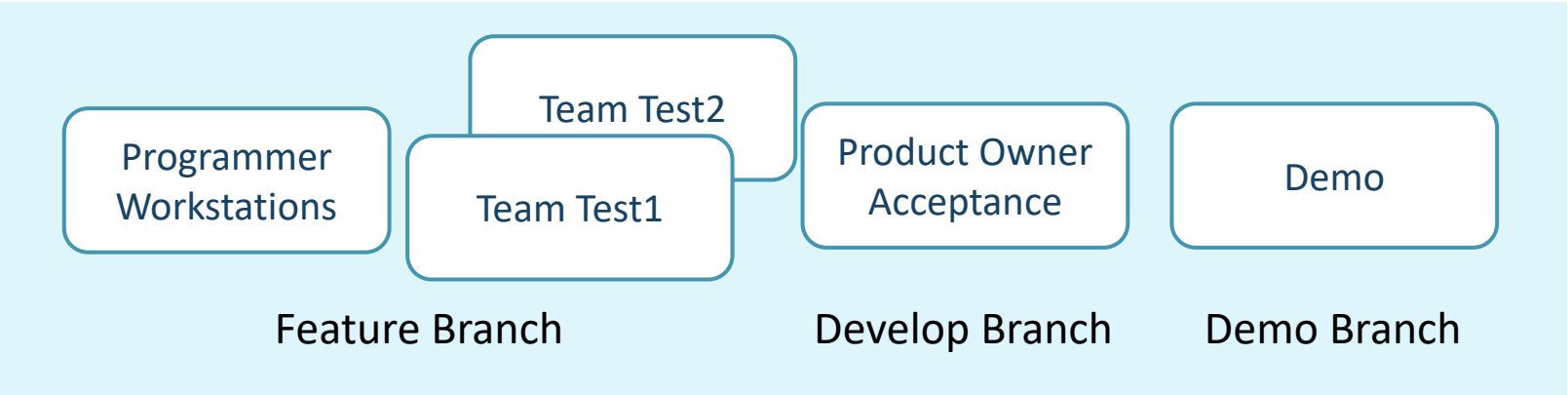
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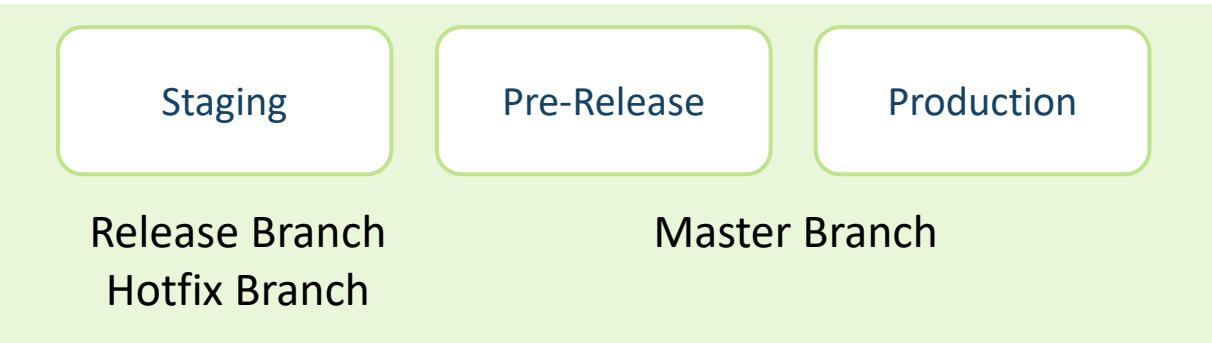
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Agile Testing and Release (QA)

Development



Release



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End of Week 3 / Day 1

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